

Scientists Discover Stonehenge-like Circle in Denmark

Danish researchers have announced the discovery of a collection of wooden pieces placed in a circle that are believed to date back thousands of years ago.

The team says the wood pieces and some other objects were found during building work in the northwestern Danish town of Aars. The discovery led the researchers to suggest the people who placed the wooden pieces might have been linked to a group who built Britain's famous Stonehenge stone structure.

A total of 45 ancient wood pieces were discovered underground last week during building, or construction, work. The pieces formed a circle about 30 meters across.

In an email to the French news agency AFP, Sidsel Wahlin of the town's Vesthimmerlands museum described the discovery as "a once in a lifetime find."

The circle "points to a strong connection with the British henge world," she added.

The British Museum says on its website the first stones placed at Stonehenge, in southern England, are believed to have started arriving there around 3000 BC.

The Danish researchers said they were also looking to see whether an inner circle might also exist where the wooden pieces were found. Wahlin noted that in the past, other wood circles had been found on the Danish island of Bornholm in the Baltic Sea.

But Wahlin said the circle in Aars was "the first one of this larger type that we can properly investigate."

Archeologists working at the building site also found an ancient settlement that included a leader's grave and a bronze sword.

Wahlin said her team was still carrying out detailed work in the area in an effort to estimate the age and purpose of the materials.

In particular, the archeologists are now searching for religious-connected materials known as "ritual deposits." These might include flint arrow heads and small knives or daggers.

Wahlin said the researchers will continue looking for links between the Aars site and other groups, such as those who built Stonehenge. She added the influence of other groups had already been found in some objects and graves found in Denmark.

I'm John Russell.

John Russell adapted this story based on an AFP report.

Vocabulary

henge - n. โครงสร้างวงกลมยุคสำริดชนิดหนึ่ง

type - n. ชนิด ประเภท หรือกลุ่มโดยเฉพาะ

ritual - n. พิธีกรรม กิจกรรม หรือชุดการกระทำที่ทำอย่างสม่ำเสมอในลักษณะเดียวกันหรือในเวลาเดียวกัน บางครั้งเป็นส่วนหนึ่งของศาสนา

deposit - n. สิ่งที่ถูกวางไว้ หรือถูกทับถมลงมา

Reading Comprehension Quiz

1. What did Danish researchers recently announce the discovery of?

- A) A new type of stone structure
- B) A collection of wooden pieces placed in a circle
- C) An ancient burial ground
- D) Evidence of early agriculture

2. Where were the wooden pieces and other objects discovered?

- A) Near Stonehenge in Britain
- B) In a forest in southern England
- C) During building work in Aars, Denmark
- D) On the Danish island of Bornholm

3. What significant connection did researchers suggest based on the discovery?

- A) A link to ancient Roman settlements
- B) A connection to early Viking trade routes
- C) A possible link to the builders of Britain's Stonehenge
- D) Evidence of the world's first calendar

4. How many ancient wood pieces were discovered?

- A) Exactly 30
- B) Approximately 40
- C) A total of 45
- D) More than 50

5. What was the approximate diameter of the circle formed by the wooden pieces?

- A) 10 meters
- B) 20 meters
- C) 30 meters
- D) 45 meters

6. How did Sidsel Wahlin of the Vesthimmerlands museum characterize the discovery?

- A) As a common archaeological occurrence
- B) As a discovery that needs further verification
- C) As “a once in a lifetime find”
- D) As a disappointing result

7. According to Sidsel Wahlin, what does the discovered circle indicate?

- A) An unknown ancient language
- B) A strong connection to the British henge world
- C) The presence of volcanic activity
- D) A new species of tree

8. When are the first stones believed to have arrived at Stonehenge, according to the British Museum?

- A) Around 5000 BC
- B) Approximately 2000 BC
- C) Around 3000 BC
- D) In the first century AD

9. What further investigation were Danish researchers considering at the site?

- A) Searching for ancient ships
- B) Looking for a possible inner circle
- C) Analyzing the soil composition
- D) Documenting local folklore

10. Where else in Denmark have wood circles been discovered in the past?

- A) Near Copenhagen
- B) On the island of Bornholm
- C) In the Jutland peninsula
- D) Along the North Sea coast

11. What distinguishes the Aars circle from other past discoveries of wood circles in Denmark, according to Wahlin?

- A) It's the only one found on the mainland
- B) It's made of a different kind of wood
- C) It's the first larger type that can be properly investigated
- D) It's the most recent discovery

12. In addition to the wooden circle, what else did archaeologists find at the building site?

- A) A modern construction blueprint
- B) A forgotten shipwreck
- C) An ancient settlement with a leader's grave and a bronze sword
- D) Evidence of volcanic ash

13. What specific efforts is Wahlin's team undertaking in the area?

- A) Preparing the site for new construction
- B) Estimating the age and purpose of the materials
- C) Mapping the entire town of Aars
- D) Training new archaeological interns

14. What specific type of materials are archaeologists currently searching for that are connected to religion?

- A) Everyday household items
- B) Large stone monuments
- C) "Ritual deposits" like flint arrowheads and daggers
- D) Ancient currency

15. What ongoing task will the researchers continue to perform regarding the Aars site?

- A) Publishing their findings in popular magazines
- B) Closing the site to the public
- C) Looking for links between the Aars site and other groups like Stonehenge builders
- D) Transporting all artifacts to a central museum